Frases para entrevistas y método STAR

Oct 13, 2026 · @Enzo

Estas son las frases que más vas a usar en una entrevista, ordenadas según el momento de la conversación. Aprendelas de memoria y practicalas en voz alta hasta que salgan sin pensar.

1. Small talk y apertura

Los primeros 2 minutos son de charla informal. Respuestas cortas, amables y con una pregunta de vuelta.

Te dicen	Respuesta natural
How are you doing today?	I'm doing well, thanks. How about you?
Can you hear me OK?	Yes, I can hear you perfectly. Can you hear me?
Did you find the link OK?	Yes, no problem at all.
Where are you based?	I'm based in Buenos Aires, Argentina.
How's your week going?	Pretty busy, but good. We're closing a release this week.
Thanks for taking the time.	Thank you for having me. I'm excited to learn more about the role.

Si hay un problema técnico: "Sorry, I think my connection dropped for a second. Could you repeat the last part?" / "Give me one second, I'm going to restart my camera."

Error típico: contestar "Fine, and you?" de forma seca. Suena a libro de texto. Agregá un detalle: "Doing great, thanks. It's a sunny day here in Buenos Aires."

2. Tell me about yourself

Es la primera pregunta en casi todas las entrevistas. Respondé en 60 a 90 segundos con la estructura **presente, pasado, futuro**: cada parte usa su tiempo verbal.

Parte	Qué decís	Tiempo verbal	Frases para arrancar
Presente	Tu rol actual y en qué te enfocás	Present Simple + Present Continuous	I'm a QA Automation Engineer at... / Right now I'm focusing on...
Experiencia acumulada	Años, tecnologías, logros sin fecha	Present Perfect (+ Continuous)	I've been working in QA for... / I've built... / I've worked with...
Pasado concreto	Un logro o paso importante con contexto	Past Simple	At my previous company, I led... / In 2023, I moved to automation...
Futuro	Por qué este rol y qué buscás	Present Simple + going to / would like	That's why I'm interested in this role... / I'd like to grow into...

Plantilla para completar

> I'm a **[rol]** with **[X]** years of experience in **[área]**. Right now I'm working at **[empresa / tipo de empresa]**, where I **[responsabilidad principal]**.
>
> Over the past **[X]** years, I've worked with **[herramientas]**, and I've **[logro con número]**.
>
> Before that, I **[paso anterior en Past Simple]**.
>
> Lately I've been getting more into **[AI / LLM testing / agentes]**, and that's why this role caught my attention: **[razón concreta del puesto]**.

Ejemplo (cambiá los datos por los tuyos)

> I'm a QA Automation Engineer with five years of experience in web and API testing. Right now I'm working at a fintech company, where I own the end-to-end test suite for our payments platform.
>
> Over the past few years, I've worked mainly with Playwright, TypeScript and Postman, and I've reduced our regression time from four hours to about forty minutes by running tests in parallel in CI.
>
> Before that, I started as a manual tester, which taught me a lot about thinking like a user.
>
> Lately I've been building small tools with LLMs to generate test data and review test cases, and that's why this AI Engineering role caught my attention: I'd like to combine my testing background with AI.

Errores típicos acá: "I have 5 years of experience" está bien, pero "I have 5 years working" no; decí "I've been working for 5 years". Y no cuentes tu vida desde la facultad: arrancá por el presente.

3. Hablar de experiencia y logros

Un logro convence cuando tiene **verbo de acción + qué hiciste + resultado con número**. "I helped with testing" no dice nada; "I automated 200 regression tests and cut release time by 50%" sí.

Para	Frase
Experiencia general	I've been working in QA for five years, mostly on web and API testing.
Herramientas	I have hands-on experience with Playwright, Cypress and Postman.
Profundidad	I'm very comfortable with TypeScript, and I have a working knowledge of Python.
Responsabilidad	I was responsible for the whole regression suite. / I owned the test strategy for the mobile app.
Logro con número	I reduced flaky tests from 15% to under 2%.
Impacto en el equipo	This allowed the team to release twice a week instead of once a month.
Iniciativa	I proposed moving our tests to CI, and the team adopted it.
Colaboración	I worked closely with developers and product to define acceptance criteria.

Para	Frase
Aprendizaje	It taught me how important it is to test early.

Verbos de acción (en pasado, para logros)

Verbo	Ejemplo
built	I built a test framework from scratch with Playwright and TypeScript.
designed	I designed the test strategy for a new microservice.
automated	I automated the onboarding flow end to end.
implemented	I implemented contract testing between the frontend and the API.
reduced / cut	I cut the pipeline time by 60%.
increased / improved	I increased test coverage from 40% to 75%.
led	I led the migration from Selenium to Playwright.
introduced	I introduced code reviews for test code.
identified / caught	I caught a critical payment bug before the release.
mentored	I mentored two junior testers.
streamlined	I streamlined the bug triage process.
set up	I set up a nightly regression job in GitHub Actions.

Ojo con el tiempo: si decís cuándo o dónde ("at my previous job", "last year"), va Past Simple. Si hablás de tu experiencia en general, sin momento, va Present Perfect: "I've led two framework migrations."

4. Método STAR

STAR es la forma estándar de responder "Tell me about a time when...". Una buena respuesta dura entre 2 y 3 minutos y el 60% del tiempo va en la **Action**. La historia es pasada, así que el tiempo base es **Past Simple**; los otros tiempos ayudan a ordenar la historia.

Parte	Qué contás	Tiempos verbales	Frases para arrancar
Situation	Contexto: dónde, qué pasaba, cuál era el problema	Past Simple, Past Continuous (fondo), Past Perfect (lo que había pasado antes)	In my previous role, I was working on... / At the time, the team was struggling with... / The company had never...
Task	Tu responsabilidad o el objetivo	Past Simple, was/were + to	I was responsible for... / My goal was to... / I needed to...
Action	Lo que hiciste vos, paso a paso	Past Simple (en primera persona: I, no we)	First, I... / Then I... / After that... / I also made sure that...
Result	El resultado con números y lo que aprendiste	Past Simple + Present Perfect para el impacto que sigue	As a result,... / This reduced... / Since then, the team has... / What I learned was...

Conectores para que la historia fluya

Para	Conectores
Ordenar pasos	First, ... / Then, ... / After that, ... / Finally, ...
Explicar causa	because / since / so / that's why
Contraste	However, ... / but / even though / although
Resultado	As a result, ... / In the end, ... / This meant that...
Tiempo	At the time, ... / By then, ... / Meanwhile, ... / A few weeks later, ...

Plantilla

> **S:** In my previous role at **[empresa]**, we were **[contexto en Past Continuous]**. The problem was that **[problema]**.
>
> **T:** I was responsible for **[tu objetivo]**.
>
> **A:** First, I **[acción 1]**. Then I **[acción 2]**. I also **[acción 3]**.
>
> **R:** As a result, **[resultado con número]**. Since then, **[impacto que sigue, Present Perfect]**. What I learned was **[aprendizaje]**.

Ejemplo: "Tell me about a time when you found a critical bug"

> **S:** In my previous role, I was testing a new payment flow two days before a major release. The developers had already marked the feature as done, and the team was under a lot of pressure.
>
> **T:** My job was to run the final regression and give the go or no-go for the release.
>
> **A:** While I was running some edge cases, I noticed that payments with certain currencies were rounded incorrectly. First, I reproduced the issue with different amounts to make sure it wasn't a data problem. Then I wrote a clear bug report with steps, logs and the expected values, and I flagged it as a blocker in the stand-up. I also paired with the developer to find the root cause, and I added an automated test for that case.
>
> **R:** As a result, we fixed it before the release and avoided incorrect charges to thousands of users. Since then, the team has added currency edge cases to the regression suite. What I learned was that edge cases deserve time even when the deadline is tight.

Errores típicos en STAR: usar "we" todo el tiempo (el entrevistador quiere saber qué hiciste vos), contar la historia en presente ("So I go and I see the bug...") y terminar sin resultado.

5. Ganar tiempo, pedir que repitan y decir que no sabés

Quedarte en silencio o decir "eeeh" mucho tiempo pone nervioso al entrevistador. Estas frases te dan 3 a 5 segundos para pensar y suenan profesionales.

Situación	Frases
Ganar tiempo	That's a great question, let me think about it for a second. / Let me think about the best example. / Good question. Off the top of my head...

Situación	Frases
No entendiste	Sorry, could you repeat the question? / Could you say that again, please? / Sorry, I didn't catch the last part.
Confirmar que entendiste	Just to make sure I understand, you're asking about... right? / Do you mean... or...?
Pedir que hablen más lento	Would you mind speaking a little more slowly? My connection is a bit unstable.
No sabés la respuesta	I haven't worked with that directly, but here's how I would approach it... / I'm not 100% sure, but my understanding is that...
No sabés una herramienta	I haven't used Kafka myself, but I've worked with RabbitMQ, which is similar in...
Ordenar una respuesta larga	There are three main things I'd consider. First,...
Volver al tema	Sorry, I went off on a tangent. To answer your question,...
Cerrar una respuesta	So, in short,... / Does that answer your question? / I'm happy to go deeper into any of that.
No encontrás una palabra	I'm not sure of the exact word in English, but it's when...

Regla de oro: nunca inventes. "I haven't worked with that, but..." y después explicar cómo lo encararías da mejor impresión que una respuesta vaga. Ojo con el tiempo verbal: es **I haven't worked** (Present Perfect, experiencia hasta hoy), no "I didn't work with that".

6. Preguntas para el entrevistador y cierre

Siempre llevá 2 o 3 preguntas preparadas. "No, I don't have any questions" suena a poco interés.

Sobre	Pregunta
El equipo	How is the QA team structured? Do testers sit within the product teams?
El día a día	What does a typical day look like for someone in this role?
Testing	What does your current test automation setup look like?
Calidad	How do you balance speed and quality when a deadline is tight?
CI/CD	How often do you deploy to production, and what runs in the pipeline?
IA	Are you using AI or LLMs in your testing or development process?
Desafíos	What's the biggest quality challenge the team is facing right now?
Expectativas	What would success look like in the first three to six months?
Crecimiento	What opportunities are there to grow into AI or platform work?
Proceso	What are the next steps in the process?

Para cerrar

- Thank you so much for your time. I really enjoyed our conversation.
- I'm even more excited about the role after talking to you.

- It was great to learn more about the team and the product.
- Looking forward to hearing from you.

Error típico: "I wait your answer" o "I stay attentive" (traducciones de "quedo a la espera" / "quedo atento"). Lo natural es "Looking forward to hearing from you."

7. Frases que suenan raras traducidas del español

Lo que sale del español	Lo natural en inglés	Por qué
I have 30 years.	I'm 30 (years old).	La edad va con to be.
I work here since 2021.	I've worked here since 2021.	"Desde" con algo que sigue pide Present Perfect.
Explain me how it works.	Explain to me how it works. / Can you explain how it works?	Explain no lleva objeto directo de persona.
It depends of the team.	It depends on the team.	Depend on, siempre.
I'm agree.	I agree.	Agree es verbo, no adjetivo.
Make a question.	Ask a question.	Las preguntas se "ask".
I have a doubt.	I have a question.	Doubt es desconfianza, no consulta.
Actually I work at X. (= actualmente)	Currently I work at X.	Actually = en realidad.
Eventually we will migrate. (= eventualmente)	We might migrate at some point.	Eventually = finalmente, al final.
I assisted to the meeting.	I attended the meeting.	Assist = ayudar.
The responsible of testing.	The person responsible for testing. / The testing owner.	Responsible es adjetivo; usa for.
I'm very interesting in this role.	I'm very interested in this role.	Interested = interesado; interesting = interesante.
I learned a lot of things.	I learned a lot.	Más natural y directo.
We realized the tests. (= realizamos)	We ran / did / carried out the tests.	Realize = darse cuenta.
I'm working in QA since 5 years.	I've been working in QA for 5 years.	For + duración, con Present Perfect Continuous.
Is there a possibility to...?	Would it be possible to...?	Suena más natural y cortés.
I stay attentive. / I wait your answer.	Looking forward to hearing from you.	Cierre estándar en mails y entrevistas.
The last week I fixed...	Last week I fixed...	Last week, next month, this year: sin "the".

Cómo usar esta tabla: tapá la columna del medio y tratá de corregir la primera vos solo. Si una de estas frases se te escapa en un simulacro, va al registro de errores.